FIGHTERBASE

Mediterranean

Diet guide

Olive oil, fish, veg, legumes and whole grains.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Mediterranean**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Mediterranean?

Based on traditional eating around the Mediterranean Sea. Lots of plants, olive oil as the main fat, fish often, meat less often. One of the most studied ways of eating.

Where it comes from

Based on the traditional eating of countries around the Mediterranean Sea, especially Greece, southern Italy and Spain in the mid-twentieth century. It is one of the most studied dietary patterns for heart health.

The main ideas

1. Vegetables, fruit, beans, lentils, nuts, seeds and wholegrains at most meals.
2. Olive oil is the main fat.
3. Fish and seafood at least twice a week.
4. Poultry, eggs and dairy in moderate amounts.
5. Red meat and sweets only occasionally.
6. Meals are social and unhurried where possible; wine is optional and in moderation.

Who it suits

- People who want a flexible, well-studied pattern
- People who enjoy cooking with fresh food
- Anyone wanting an eating style that works for the whole family

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
> - You have a health condition that needs a specific diet
> - You are pregnant (fish choices matter)
> - You have a nut or seafood allergy (you can still follow the style with swaps)

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Wholegrain bread, pasta, rice, couscous and potatoes cover the carbs around training.
- Fish, eggs, yoghurt, chicken and beans cover protein.
- Fruit with yoghurt or nuts is a good snack before or after sessions.
- Olive oil is dense in calories: handy in camp, easy to overdo when cutting.

> Naturally carb-rich, so fuelling is easy: pasta, bread or rice before hard sessions, fish or yoghurt-based meals after.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Protein
can run low if meals are mostly vegetables and grains
Where: fish, poultry, eggs, yoghurt, beans

Iron
less red meat
Where: lentils, beans, greens, seafood, red meat now and then

Omega-3
heart and recovery
Where: oily fish such as salmon, sardines, mackerel; walnuts

Sodium
olives, cured fish and cheese can be salty
Where: taste before adding salt

Common mistakes

- Treating olive oil as unlimited
- Pasta and bread as the whole meal with little protein
- Buying 'Mediterranean' labelled products that are processed
- Skipping fish

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Extra virgin olive oil: look for harvest date and dark bottle
- Feta, olives and anchovies are high in salt
- Sweet 'Mediterranean' dressings often carry added sugar

Eating out

- Greek, Italian and Spanish menus fit well: grilled fish, souvlaki, salads, bean stews, tapas.
- Choose tomato-based over cream-based sauces.
- Share starters of olives, hummus and grilled veg.

Easy swaps

Butter	→	Olive oil
Sausage or bacon	→	Sardines, eggs or grilled chicken
White pasta	→	Wholewheat pasta or bean pasta
Sweet dessert	→	Fruit with yoghurt, nuts and a drizzle of honey

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Greek yoghurt, honey, walnuts, fruit	Chickpea and tomato salad, wholemeal pitta	Grilled sea bass, roast veg, couscous
Tue	Eggs, tomatoes, wholegrain toast	Lentil soup, salad	Chicken souvlaki, rice, tzatziki
Wed	Porridge with figs and almonds	Tuna, white bean and rocket salad	Prawn and vegetable pasta
Thu	Yoghurt and berries	Hummus, veg and falafel wrap	Baked salmon, potatoes, greens
Fri	Omelette with feta and spinach	Minestrone and bread	Chicken and chickpea tagine
Sat	Wholegrain toast with avocado and tomato	Greek salad with grilled chicken	Mackerel, lentils, roast peppers
Sun	Shakshuka	Leftovers bowl	Slow-cooked lamb or bean stew with vegetables

Snacks

Olives · Fruit and almonds · Hummus and carrot sticks · Yoghurt · Wholegrain crackers and tomato

Shopping list

Extra virgin olive oil, vinegar, lemons · Tinned tomatoes, chickpeas, white beans, lentils · Fish (fresh, frozen, tinned), chicken, eggs · Wholegrain bread, pasta, rice, couscous · Vegetables, fruit, herbs · Nuts, seeds, feta, yoghurt

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Do I have to drink wine?

No. It is optional. If you do not already drink, there is no reason to start.

Is it good for losing weight?

It can be, because it is rich in fibre and protein-containing whole foods. Portion sizes still matter, especially oil, bread and nuts.

Further reading

British Heart Foundation; Mediterranean diet pyramid summaries from the Oldways organisation; NHS.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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